

Proposal for Emoji: OFF-ROAD HELMET

Submitter: Luca Milo¹ (main point of contact)

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Identification

CLDR Short Name: off-road helmet

CLDR Keywords: motocross, enduro, downhill, aquabike, ATV, supercross, supermoto, freestyle, BMX, PWC, jet ski, goggles, gear, rider, protection

Category: Activities → sport; proposed to appear among the sports equipment, near 🛹 roller skates, 🏂 sled and 🏏 curling stone.

Images



License



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¹  [0009-0000-9709-299X](https://orcid.org/0009-0000-9709-299X)

Factors for Inclusion

Expresses multiple concepts

The off-road helmet — distinguished by its peak (sun visor), elongated chin bar, and open port worn with goggles — is the shared icon of an entire family of sports and of everyday riding culture:

- **The off-road sports family:** motocross, supercross, enduro, freestyle motocross, ATV/quad racing, snow-bike, downhill and freeride mountain biking, BMX racing, aquabike racing² the helmets of all these disciplines share the same design, a single character could cover them all.
- **Everyday riding:** the off-road helmet is a mass consumer product well beyond competition. The global motorcycle helmet market was valued at ~USD 3.35 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 4.52 billion by 2030 (CAGR 5.1%), with off-road/racing helmets a distinct product segment³ for the off-road segment specifically, the off-road motorcycle accessories market, including helmets and goggles, is projected to reach USD 3.32 billion by 2034 (CAGR 5.1%)⁴. On the road it is the helmet of choice of the supermoto scene, MX-style helmets are in regular street use⁵, and the MX-derived “dual-sport” helmet is treated as a mainstream on/off-road street category⁶. In Southern Europe and Latin America, motocross-style helmets are everyday wear on motorcycles and even scooters^{7,8,9}. The object reads as “rider”, not only “off-road racer”¹⁰.
- **Protective gear / safety:** the helmet is the universal symbol of rider protection (“wear your helmet”, “all the gear, all the time”).
- **Adventure and grit:** off-road riding metaphors → getting dirty, rough terrain, “send it”.
- **Preparation / gearing up:** putting on the helmet → about to start, committing to action.

Use in sequences

- 🏍️ + [off-road helmet] → motocross / enduro riding (vs. 🏍️ alone = road riding)
- 🚲 + [off-road helmet] → downhill / freeride MTB (vs. 🚲 alone = cross-country)
- 🌊 + [off-road helmet] → personal-watercraft racing (PWC / aquabike / “jet ski”)
- [off-road helmet] + 🏜️ / 🌵 / 🌲 → trail, desert, woods riding

²The UIM-ABP Aquabike World Championship, governed by the Union Internationale Motonautique (<https://www.aquabike.net/>); colloquially “jet ski” racing, after the genericized Kawasaki trademark. Competitors wear motocross/off-road helmets: Kevin Shaw, *Real Review: Fly Racing F2 Acetylene Helmet* (a motocross helmet reviewed for PWC use), The Watercraft Journal, <https://watercraftjournal.com/real-review-fly-racing-f2-acetylene-helmet/>.

³Grand View Research, *Motorcycle Helmet Market Size, Share & Trends Analysis Report, 2025–2030*, <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/motorcycle-helmet-market>. “Off-road/Racing Helmets” is one of the report’s product-type segments.

⁴Fact.MR, *Off-Road Motorcycle Accessories Market, 2024–2034* (USD 2,020.1 million in 2024 → USD 3,322.0 million by 2034), via GlobeNewswire, <https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2024/11/11/2978189/0/en/Off-Road-Motorcycle-Accessories-Market-Set-to-Surge-at-5-1-CAGR-to-Reach-US-3-322-0-Million-by-2034-Fact-MR-Report.html>.

⁵Michael Parrotte (founder of AGV Sports Group; former Vice-President of AGV Helmets America), *Can I Use a MX Style Motocross Dirt Bike Helmet on the Road for Street Riding?*, AGVSPORT, <https://agvsport.com/blog/most-popular/dirt-bike-helmet-for-road.html>.

⁶Kurt Spurlock, *7 Best Dual Sport Helmets*, RIDE Adventures, <https://www.rideadv.com/ride-adventures-tour-and-rentals-blog/best-dual-sport-helmets> and RoadRUNNER, *9 Best Motorcycle Helmets for Dual Sport Riding*, <https://www.roadrunner.travel/products/9-best-motorcycle-helmets-for-dual-sport-riding/>. Both treat the MX-derived dual-sport helmet as a versatile street/off-road category.

⁷Passion Moto Sécurité^[fr], *Les différents types de casques moto*, <https://moto-securite.fr/types-casques/>. The cross helmet is “prisé des jeunes conducteurs urbains de cyclomoteurs” (“popular with young urban moped riders”).

⁸La Bécannerie^[fr], *Casque moto*, <https://www.la-becannerie.com/casque/>. Cross helmets are “fréquent [...] sur de jeunes pilotes de 50 à boîte” (“common [...] on young riders of geared 50cc mopeds”).

⁹Inducascos^[es], *La moda del casco cross se traslada de la pista a la ciudad* (“the cross-helmet trend moves from the track to the city”), 2022, <https://www.inducascos.com/blog/post/casco-cross-como-usar>.

¹⁰Expanded in [§Helmet as identity](#), under [§Other information](#).

- [off-road helmet] + 🌊 → freestyle on the water
- [off-road helmet] + 🏁 → race day
- 🏍️ + [off-road helmet] → “gear up”, everyday commute
- 🧤 + [off-road helmet] → “gearing up” / pre-ride ritual
- [off-road helmet] + 🌀 → riding fast, roosting

Breaks new ground

Yes. The off-road helmet is to its sports what skis are to skiing or the snowboard to snowboarding: the single most idiomatic piece of equipment, the object that identifies the discipline. It would be:

1. The first symbol for the off-road riding cluster (motocross, enduro, downhill, BMX, ATV) and for aquabike (personal-watercraft) racing, a family of sports with zero current emoji representation. 🏍️ depicts a road racing motorcycle, 🚴 cross-country mountain biking and no aquatic emoji depicts aquabike riding or racing.
2. An *equipment* symbol carrying meanings the activity emoji cannot (gear, safety, identity, anticipation)¹⁰, in the role that the ball, the skis or the board play for other sports.
3. Not a variant of anything encoded: the only existing helmets, 🧢 and 🛑, are occupational objects with unrelated meanings.

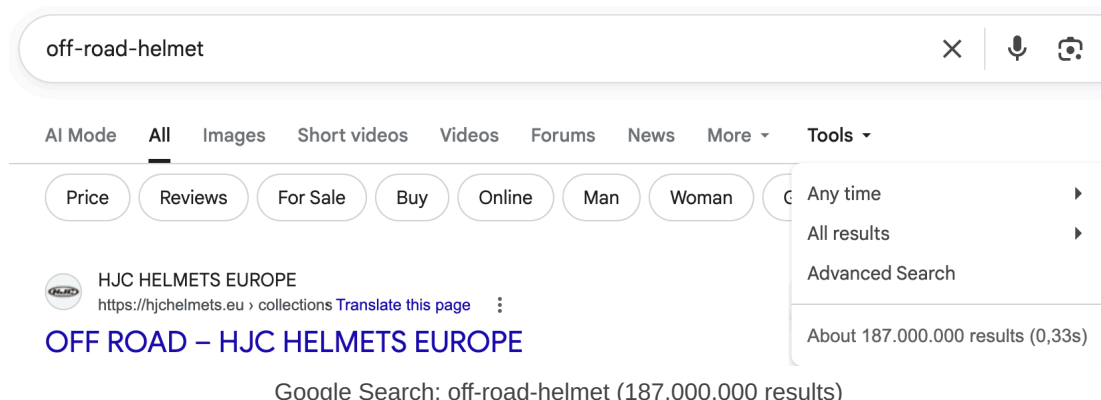
Distinctiveness

The off-road helmet has the most recognizable helmet silhouette in sport: the protruding **peak/sun visor**, the **elongated chin bar**, and the **goggle strap** across the shell. This three-element signature is unique among helmets: full-face road helmets have no peak and an integrated visor; bicycle and ski helmets are open-faced; 🧢 and 🛑 are visually unrelated. The silhouette survives at 18×18 pixels, as shown by the example images above.

Usage level: evidence of frequency

The concept carries an active family of names, each strongest in a different measurement context: “**off-road helmet**”, the proposed name, is the category/retail term and by far the strongest in web search; “**motocross helmet**” and “**dirt bike helmet**” are the colloquial discipline names (≈1:1 with each other on Google Trends¹¹) and the strongest in interest-over-time data. Each tool below is therefore reported with its strongest term, with synonyms as supplements; all queries are listed and reproducible.

- Google Search [off-road-helmet] (the proposed name): **187,000,000 results; 34% of “elephant”** (546,000,000); synonyms [dirt-bike-helmet]: **54,700,000**; [motocross-helmet]: **25,100,000**
- Google Video Search [off-road-helmet]: **24,200,000 results; 43% of “elephant”** (55,900,000)



¹¹See [\\$Google Trends: discipline-term breakdown \(motocross / dirt bike / mx / enduro / downhill helmet\)](#).

elephant

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AI Mode

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See results about

 Elephants
Animal

 African elephants
Animal

Wikipedia

https://en.wikipedia.org › wiki › Elephant ⓘ

Any time ▸

All results ▸

Advanced Search

About 546.000.000 results (0,34s)

Google Search: elephant (546,000,000 results)

dirt-bike-helmet

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AI Mode

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Videos

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Black

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Price

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24mx.eu

https://www.24mx.eu › Helmets ⓘ

Motocross Helmets

Any time ▸

All results ▸

Advanced Search

About 54.700.000 results (0,79s)

Google Search: dirt-bike-helmet (54,700,000 results)

motocross-helmet

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AI Mode

All

Images

Videos

Short videos

News

Forums

More ▾

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Nearby

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Alpinestars

https://www.alpinestars.com › collections › mx-helmets ⓘ

Motocross Helmets: Ultimate Protection for Dirt Bikes

Any time ▸

All results ▸

Advanced Search

About 25.100.000 results (0,44s)

Google Search: motocross-helmet (25,100,000 results)

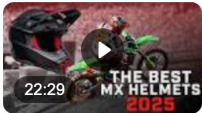
off-road-helmet

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AI Mode | All | Images | **Videos** | Forums | Short videos | Web | More ▾ | Tools ▾

www.youtube.com › watch

Best Premium Motocross Helmets | 2025



22:29

THE BEST MX HELMETS 2025

Premium MX Helmet Buyers Guide: <https://rmatvmc.link/2025-helmet-buyers-guide> Are you looking to upgrade your current i

YouTube · Rocky Mountain ATV MC · 29 May 2025

 12 key moments in this video ▾

Any duration ▸

Any time ▸

Any quality ▸

All videos ▸

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Advanced Search

About 24.200.000 results (0,15s)

Google Video Search: off-road-helmet (24,200,000 results)

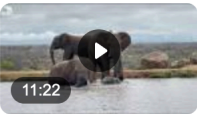
elephant

✕ | 🔊 | 📷

AI Mode | All | Images | **Videos** | News | Forums | Short videos | More ▾ | Tools ▾

www.youtube.com › watch

The Elephant Herd Loving the First Spring Rains 🌧️



11:22

Carer Owen captures a peaceful morning with the herd as the y enjoy a chilly morning swim. The air is still cool from the night's

YouTube · HERD Elephant Orphanage South Africa · 3 Nov 202

Any duration ▸

Any time ▸

Any quality ▸

All videos ▸

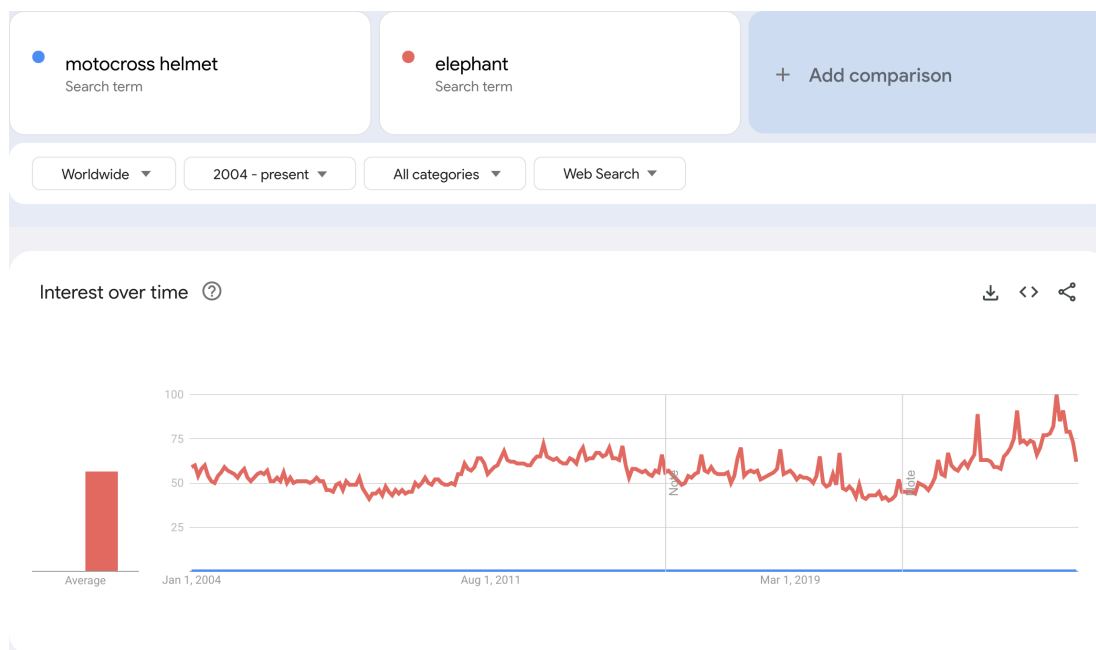
Any source ▸

Advanced Search

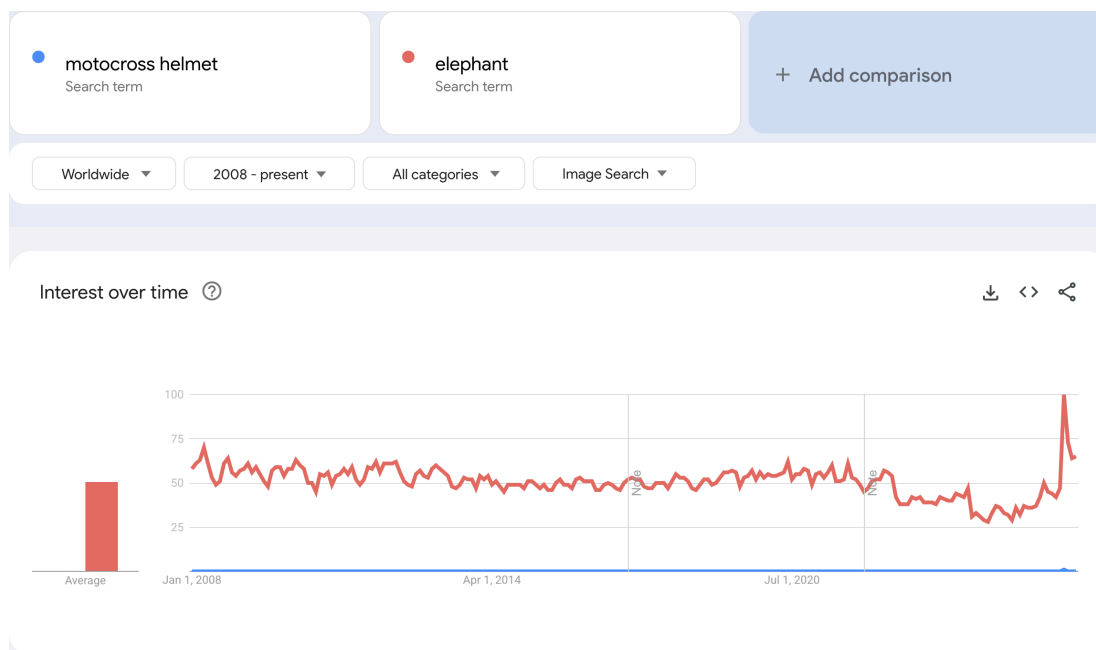
About 55.900.000 results (0,17s)

Google Video Search: elephant (55,900,000 results)

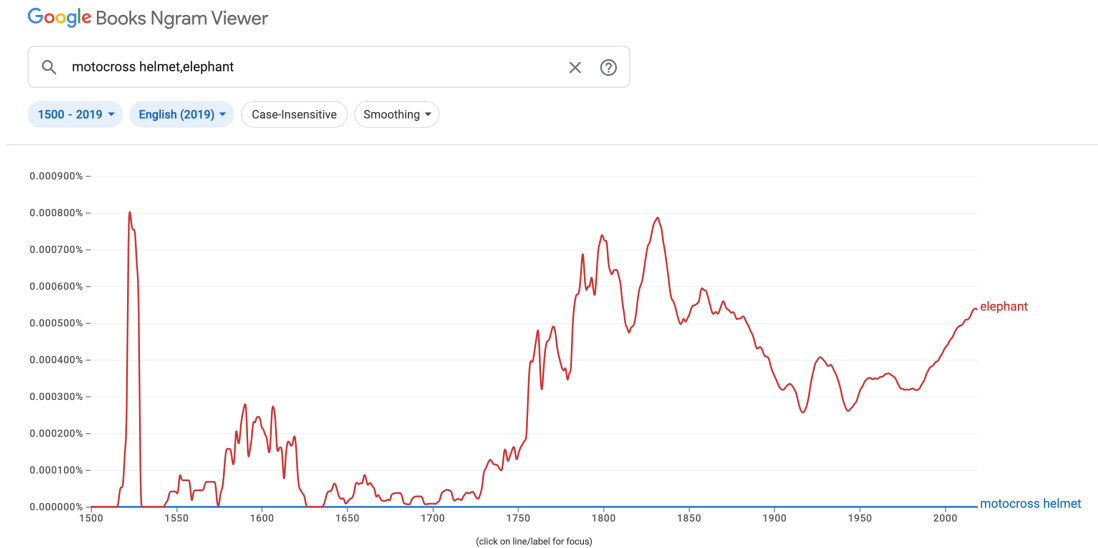
Scale and context. On the guidelines' calibration scale, the proposed concept reaches **34% of “elephant” on web search and 43% on video search**. For a single piece of sports equipment measured against one of the world's most iconic animals. The video share of its footprint (13% of results vs 10% for elephant) also slightly over-indexes, consistent with how off-road riding is communicated, usually through images and video on social platforms, precisely the messaging-adjacent environments where emoji are used. By contrast, interest-over-time and book-corpus baselines are structurally unfavorable to a modern two-word gear compound vs a millennia-old single common noun: the Trends and Ngram charts below are included per the guidelines and should be read with that calibration in mind.



Google Trends (Web Search, worldwide, 2004–present): motocross helmet vs elephant

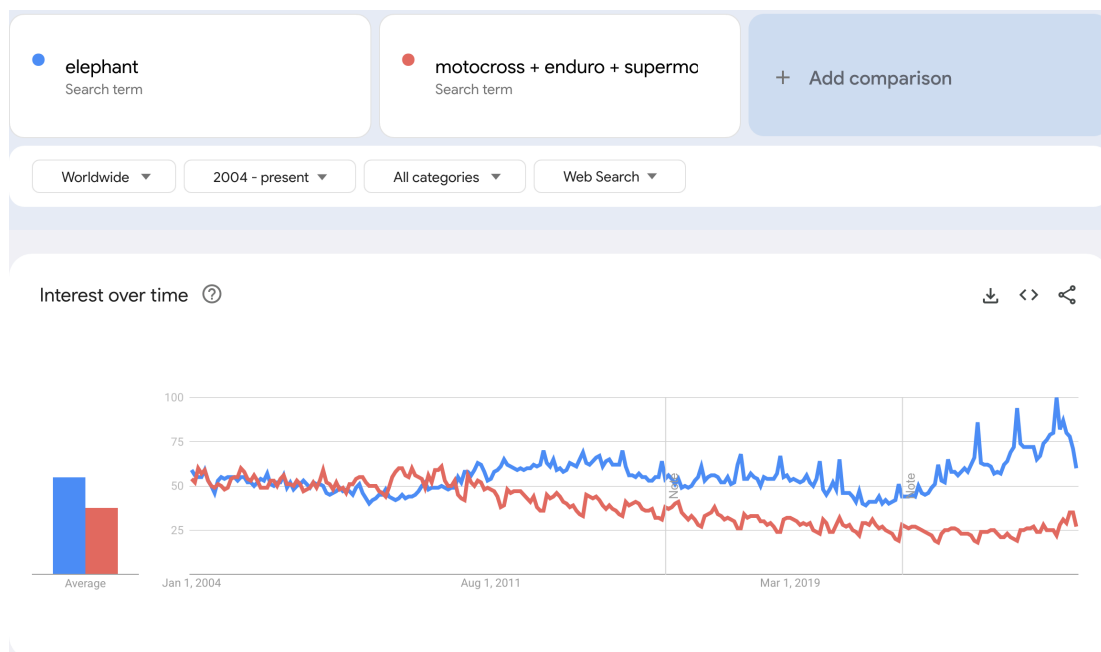


Google Trends (Image Search, worldwide, 2008–present): motocross helmet vs elephant



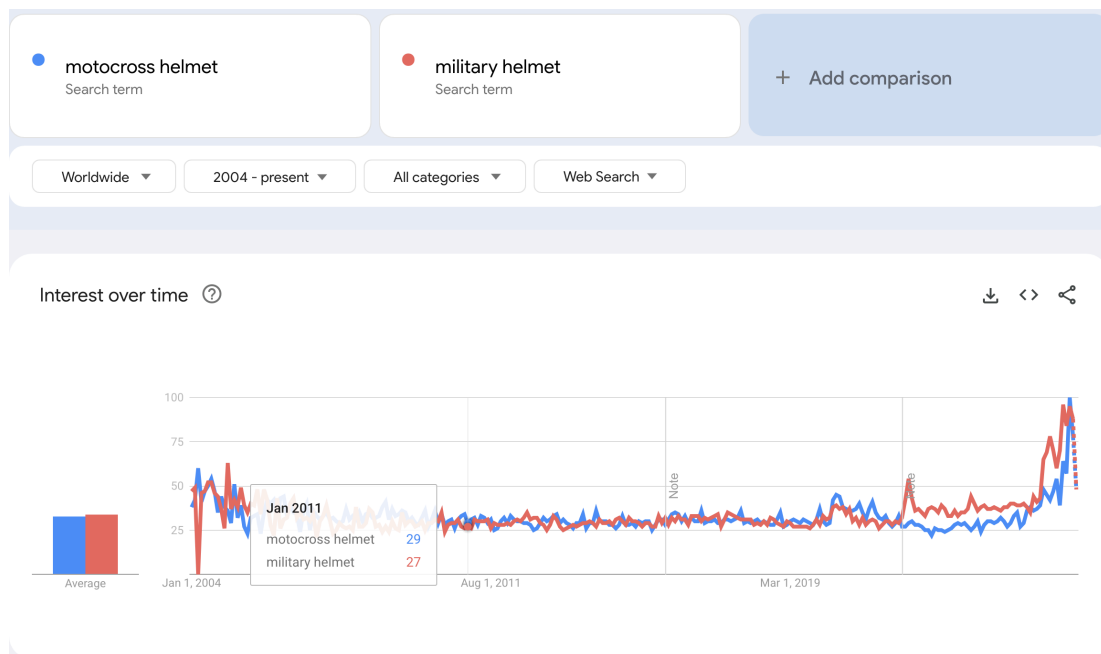
Google Books Ngram: motocross helmet vs elephant

The semantic field, measured against the calibration term. This emoji would be the sole symbol for an entire family of disciplines, none of which has any emoji today. Their combined worldwide search interest, motocross + enduro + supermoto + motard + supercross, deliberately excluding ambiguous terms (downhill) and disciplines partially covered by existing emoji (MTB/🚴), averages **38 against elephant's 55 (≈70%)** over the full Trends range (2004–present). The object-term charts above measure one name of one object; this chart measures the size of the semantic territory the single grapheme would serve.

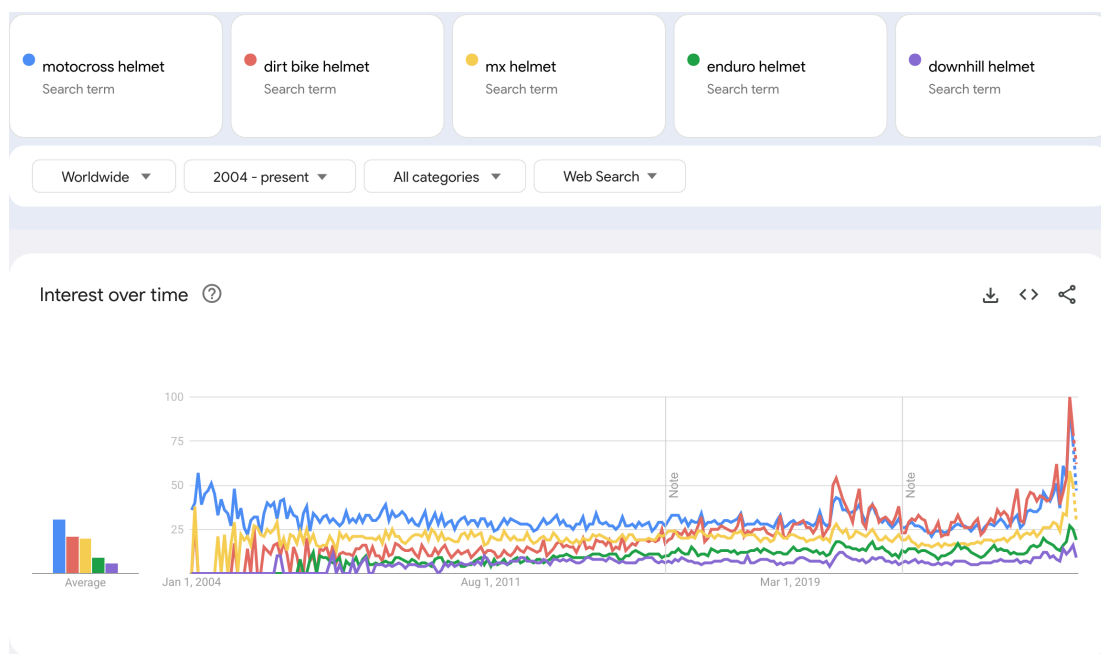


Google Trends: motocross + enduro + supermoto + motard + supercross vs elephant (38 vs 55)

Further calibration. On Google Trends, “motocross helmet” tracks **≈1:1** with “military helmet” (🪖 U+1FA96, encoded 2020) across the full range.



Google Trends: motocross helmet vs military helmet ($\approx 1:1$)



Google Trends: discipline-term breakdown (motocross / dirt bike / mx / enduro / downhill helmet)

Non-English usage. Same methodology in Italian and Spanish: [casco-da-cross] (it): **13,700,000 results**; [casco-de-motocross] (es): **10,400,000**; calibration term [elefante]: **47,900,000** (same session; “elefante” is shared by Italian, Spanish and Portuguese). The Italian-only helmet term stands at **29%** of it, mirroring the English-language ratios.

Factors for Exclusion

Not already represented

No emoji or sequence conveys off-road riding or its sports:

- 🏍️ *motorcycle* is a road racing bike; it cannot indicate off-road, and adding terrain emoji (🏔️) reads as “riding to the mountains”, not motocross.
- 🚴🏂 *person mountain biking* depicts cross-country cycling with an open bicycle helmet; it cannot represent downhill/freeride, let alone any motorized discipline.
- Aquatic emoji (🌊 water wave, 💧 sweat droplets, 🚤 speedboat, 🛥️ motor boat, 🏄🏂 surfing) depict water, boats, or other water sports; the aquatic-emoji cluster does not depict aquabike (personal-watercraft) riding or racing, nor does any combination of them.
- 🛡️ *military helmet* and 🚒 *rescue worker's helmet* are occupational objects with strong, unrelated meanings.

Not overly specific

The off-road helmet is the *category* object. One shape shared across motorized (MX, enduro, ATV, aquabike racing) and gravity (DH MTB, BMX) sports, plus everyday riding. It is the paradigm, exactly as 🍣 represents all sushi.

Not open-ended

This proposal does not start a series. Sports whose identity rests on other equipment already have their icons (🏈 American football, 🏂 skiing, 🛼 skating). The off-road helmet is proposed precisely because for its sport family the helmet *is* the icon, the only piece of equipment shared by the entire category.

Not transient

Motocross has existed for over a century: the first recorded off-road “scramble” race was the Southern Scott Scramble at Camberley Heath, England, on 29 March 1924¹², and the FIM Motocross World Championship has run continuously since 1957. The gravity disciplines are similarly established: the UCI Mountain Bike World Championships have included downhill since their first edition (Durango, 1990)¹³, BMX racing has been an Olympic discipline since Beijing 2008 and BMX freestyle since Tokyo 2020¹⁴. Media presence has been equally continuous, from the Academy Award-nominated documentary *On Any Sunday* (1971)¹⁵ to a living catalogue of video games¹⁶. A century of continuous and growing practice that has only become more institutionalized and widespread, alongside a still-growing consumer market (see [§Expresses multiple concepts](#)), is the antithesis of a passing trend.

No faulty comparison

This proposal stands on its own evidence of frequency, distinctiveness, and category gap. No argument herein relies on the existence of other emoji as justification.

¹²Racer X, *A Rare Old Scramble at Camberley Heath*, <https://raceronline.com/2024/11/12/a-rare-old-scramble-at-camberley-heath>. Wikipedia, *Motocross*, <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Motocross>.

¹³Wikipedia, *1990 UCI Mountain Bike World Championships*, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1990_UCI_Mountain_Bike_World_Championships. UCI, *30 years of UCI Mountain Bike World Championships*, <https://www.uci.org/article/30-years-of-uci-mountain-bike-world-championships/5Hwc43UPVOWiHnxYmmNMHE>.

¹⁴Olympics, *Cycling BMX Racing and Cycling BMX Freestyle*, <https://www.olympics.com/en/sports/cycling-bmx-racing/> and <https://www.olympics.com/en/sports/cycling-bmx-freestyle/>.

¹⁵Wikipedia, *On Any Sunday*, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/On_Any_Sunday.

¹⁶See, e.g., the titles under Steam's “Motocross” tag: <https://store.steampowered.com/tags/en/Motocross/>.

Other information

A note on cultural embedding. A motocross starting line has sat in the canonical reference set of image processing for three decades: kodim05 (“several motocross racers ready to begin”) of the Kodak Lossless True Color Image Suite (~1993)¹⁷ still anchors the standard image-compression benchmark today¹⁸, among others.

Helmet as identity. The helmet is a distinctive piece of the rider’s identity and sense of self within the community^{19, 20, 21}. Online spaces have a long tradition of creators who communicate — and thus exist there — through their helmet rather than their face²².

Design considerations for vendors:

- Side or three-quarter view maximizes the signature silhouette (peak + chin bar + goggle strap).
- Neutral, vendor-flexible colorway; the example images use a colorway chosen purely for legibility.
- Goggles may be drawn worn (over the shell) or omitted without losing recognizability, as the peak and chin bar alone carry the silhouette²³.

¹⁷Kodak Lossless True Color Image Suite, image 05, <http://r0k.us/graphics/kodak/kodim05.html>.

¹⁸Papers with Code, *Image Compression on Kodak benchmark*, <https://web.archive.org/web/20240416173213/https://paperswithcode.com/sota/image-compression-on-kodak>. Also see: https://orkg.org/benchmarks/PWC_KODAK_BENCHMARK_DATASET/problem/PWC_IMAGE_COMPRESSION_PROBLEM.

¹⁹Roach-Higgins, M. E. and Eicher, J. B., *Dress and Identity*, Clothing and Textiles Research Journal 10(4), 1992, pp. 1–8, <https://doi.org/10.1177/0887302X9201000401>. Dress, defined as the supplements to and modifications of the body (the helmet among them), constitutes and communicates identity.

²⁰Motorcycling culture and identity sustain a dedicated peer-reviewed journal, the *International Journal of Motorcycle Studies*, published since 2005: <https://motorcyclestudies.org>.

²¹For the off-road disciplines specifically, the ethnographic fieldwork in Hagen, S., *The Downhill Mountain Bike Subculture in New Zealand*, MPhEd thesis, University of Otago, 2013, <https://ourarchive.otago.ac.nz/handle/10523/4042>, documents the subculture’s dress and identity codes.

²²Wikipedia, *Motovlog*, <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Motovlog>.

²³Both variants are shown in [§Additional images](#).

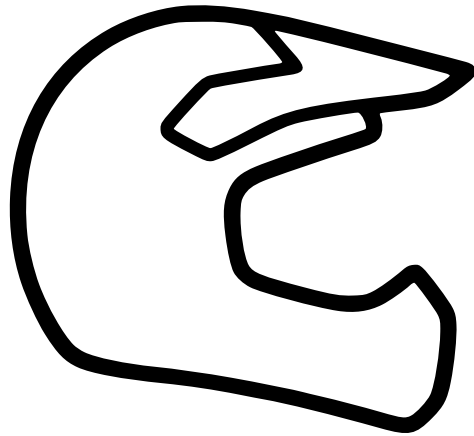
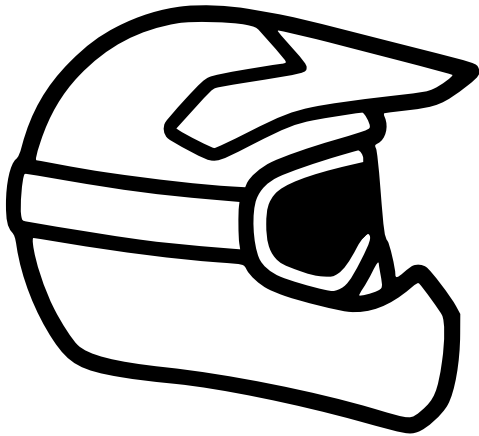
Additional images

Full-resolution renderings of the proposed emoji, in both variants²⁴.

with goggles



without goggles



²⁴Artwork by Keshav (<https://www.fiverr.com/keshav138>). Other variants can be found at <https://github.com/lucainf/offroad-emoji-proposal/blob/master/VARIANTS.md>.